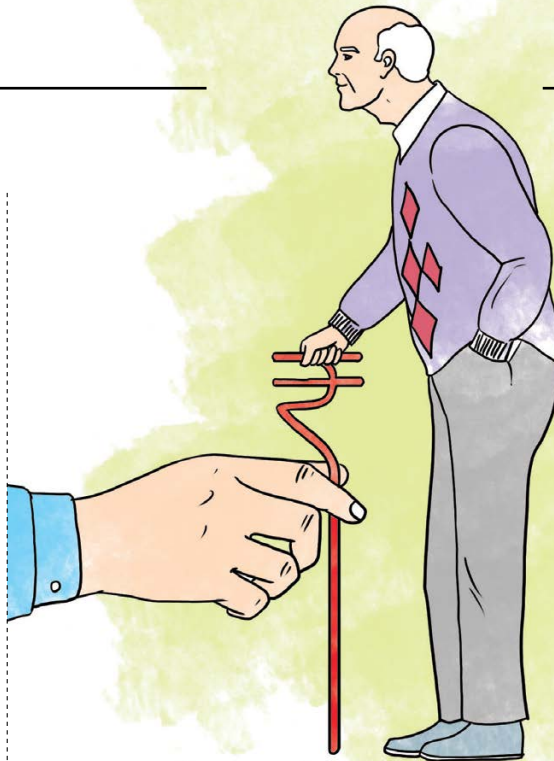


88

CHILDHOOD, NOT CHAINS

► The government must end child labour completely. By strengthening monitoring mechanisms, increasing penalties for violations, and holding employers accountable, the state can ensure that laws are enforced to fully eradicate child labour. Efforts must also focus on supporting families through social protection, education access, and livelihood opportunities to prevent children from being pushed into labour. Higher penalties must be enforced upon those found violating these laws.



89

REVISIT THE CREAMY LAYER CRITERIA

► Reform the creamy layer category to strengthen reservations for economically weaker sections (EWS) of society. To do this, it is essential to revisit and refine the creamy layer criteria across reservation categories. A more rational and uniform approach will exclude the truly privileged while prioritising genuinely disadvantaged individuals. Aligning creamy layer norms with the spirit of EWS ensures that support reaches those who need it the most, promoting a fairer and more inclusive reservation system across communities and castes.

90

DOMESTIC RIGHTS, WAGES, AND RESPECT

► The government must formalise domestic work and put an end to manual scavenging. Establishing clear regulations around contracts, wages, working hours, and social security can bring it into the formal economy, reducing exploitation. This can be done by establishing enforceable regulations around contracts, minimum wages, working hours, rest days, etc. Simultaneously, India must eliminate manual scavenging through increased mechanisation.

